

research institutions like the IITs, NCST, and IISc. ERNET was tasked with the job of connecting elite organisations involved in education and research. The network itself was also referred to as ERNET. By 1992 all organisations were connected by 9.6 kbps leased line. ERNET users could only communicate with other organisations connected by ERNET and not with the outside world, till 1992, when an international Internet Gateway was commissioned. (A Gateway refers to the connecting point between two networks.) In 1992, ERNET was connected to UUNET in Washington DC through a 64 kbps leased line.

February: First Linux Distro

Owen Le Blanc released the first Linux distribution—MCC Interim Linux. Prior to this, a user had to download bits of the operating system from different sites to be able to satisfactorily use it. Owen Le Blanc offered these essential software as a bundle with the Linux system, so users had an independent system without having to download additional packages. MCC stands for Manchester Computer Centre, where Owen was employed.

February: Version 1 Of GNU/Linux

The GNU/Linux operating system Version 1 is released. It was a fusion of the components that were built for a GNU operating system and the Linux kernel that Torvalds built. Richard Stallman of the Free Software Foundation had been working on the GNU operating system, and all components except the kernel had been completed. The Linux kernel was at the right place at the right time.

May: Gamers rejoice, First FPS Is Made

Wolfenstein 3D, one of the first ever game in the First Person Shooter (FPS) genre, was released by id Software. The game is credited with defining the genre, with activities like pushing switches, collecting health/power ups, finding hidden items, and annihilating all moving characters. The game was not true 3D since characters were flat. The game was distributed as shareware, with the first level being free and the user having to pay to unlock the higher levels.